Reagan, In His Own Hand

EDITED, WITH AN INTRODUCTION AND COMMENTARY BY

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A Note on Editorial Methods

In producing a printed version of what Reagan wrote in his own hand, we have shown his own inserts in small italic capital letters when he used them, or italics when he added in script rather than capitals. His deletions are shown with a single strike-through except where we could not read what he struck out; unreadable strike-outs are shown with only a single symbol, a ~~≠~~.

We have not corrected spelling or punctuation, nor have we expanded the abbreviations he oftèn used. His placement of apostrophes in contractions, however, was as casual as the dotting of an i, and so we have often located them at their conventional place.

In the rare cases where editorial changes were made by someone other than Reagan, we present those edits in brackets.

Reagan's marginal comments are indicated by daggers (†) and are printed at the end of the document on which they appear. Asterisks are used to indicate editors' footnotes, and are at the bottom of the page.

The titles of the documents are the titles Harry O'Connor of O'Connor Creative Services used in distributing them, rather than the even briefer identifiers Reagan used when he wrote them. The dates given are taping dates, each of which is the closest known date to the time of writing. The taping date of course preceded the distribution date and can be estimated in those cases where it is unknown. Radio broadcasts were usually taped in batches of fifteen, although at first fewer were taped at a time. Sometimes more than fifteen would be taped, and the extras held for distribution during a time when Reagan was traveling abroad and couldn't do a taping. The air dates can therefore be two to five weeks and sometimes more after the taping date.

Reagan wrote his radio commentaries in two parts. First, he used a brief introduction or "teaser" to entice the radio audience to stay tuned to the station. He would always finish this part by saying, "I'll be right back." Then, after the radio commercials, he would read his essay for the day. Each of his radio commentaries ended with: "This is Ronald Reagan. Thanks for listening."

Three different versions of most of the radio commentaries can be found in the archives. One is Reagan's handwritten draft. The typed version of Reagan's draft prepared by his staff is also in the archives. The third version is the transcript of Reagan's taping session prepared by O'Connor Creative Services. O'Connor's transcripts were distributed to radio stations so that they would know what was on the tapes or records being sent to them. The O'Connor version does not include Reagan's teaser or his sign-off.

Taiwan II

January 1979

Today I'd like to talk a little more about the "normalization" of relations with Red China & what it means. I'll be right back.

In the Presidents announcement Dec. 15th that we were ~~opening~~ establishing diplomatic relations with the Peoples Repub. of China on the mainland the inference was given that this was somehow a breakthrough, ~~≠~~ —the result of successful negotiations. This is a little less than accurate. It didn't require any negotiations to do what the admin. has done nor was this any victory as the announcement also implied.

The legitimate govt. of China some 3 decades ago was overthrown by a mil. coup led by Mao Tse Tung. That govt. fled to Taiwan and set itself up as the govt. in exile of China. Mao set up a communist govt. in Peking. Both claimed to represent all of China. The United States continued it's recognition & diplomatic relations with the *EXILED* govt. ~~of~~ on Taiwan.

In 1972 Pres. Nixon made his historic visit to Peking and opened the door to a relationship with the mainland Chinese. In the discussions & negotiations that followed, trade & cultural relations were established. But the Red Chinese govt. ~~set~~ *made* 3 demands which would have to be met before there could be full diplomatic ~~relations~~ *recognition.* Those demands were, the breaking of our ~~treaty~~ *defense* treaty with Taiwan, cancellation of diplomatic relations & the removal of all Am. military from Taiwan.

For *almost* 7 years this has been the impasse between the U.S. & Mainland China. Neither Pres. Nixon nor Pres. Ford would accede to these demands. We must remember also that Red China was the supplicant. The rulers in Peking wanted full diplomatic recognition, mainly because of their hostile relations with the Soviets ~~U.~~ ~~The~~ They had everything to gain by recognition, we gained *VIRTUALLY* nothing *we didn't already have.*

The "breakthrough" the Pres. announced on Dec. 15th was, as I said earlier, not a breakthrough at all. We simply gave in to Peking's demands. ~~The price we paid is possibly higher than we know~~
This could have been done anytime in the last 6 or 7 years ~~at any time~~ *whenever* we were ~~ready~~ *willing* to throw a loyal ally ~~out of the boat.~~ *overboard.* During those years poll after poll showed that while ¾ of the Ameri-

can people wanted ~~to~~ *to* better relations with the mainland, ¾ of them did not want to do this by dumping Taiwan.

Now I believe there are things the Congress can do to lessen the damage that has been done & I'll talk about this on the next broadcast. But one thing cannot be changed; the nations of the world have seen us cold bloodedly betray a friend for political expediency. That memory will not go away.

This is RR Thanks for listening. ❖

Treaties

March 13, 1978

In all the debate that has been going on about a couple of particular treaties there hasn't been much time for a ~~general~~ discussion of treaties in general. I'll be right back.

Laurence Beilenson a distinguished Calif. lawyer & scholar authored a book a few years ago that is quite unique. In fact it is, so far as I know, the only history of treaties ~~dating all the way back through biblical times~~ and the observance and lack of observance of ~~those~~ ~~treaties~~. *same—dating all the*

way back through biblical times. One thing stands out sharply—no nation which put it's faith in treaties ~~& consequently~~ *but let it's ~~hard~~ mil.* hardware deteriorate stayed around very long.

The very nature of treaties is such that more often than not they must be written in 2 languages. The result is that regardless of the good will of the signatories the different meaning of words when translated from one language to another can make for misunderstandings.

Let's take an agreement which while not a formal treaty was still a joint communiqué between the heads of state of 2 nations enunciating a policy. I'm talking about the Shanghai communique that climaxed the visit of an American Pres. to the Peoples Republic of China a few years ago. In looking at it one is apt to be more confused than enlightened.

The Chinese made a statement with ~~≠~~ regard to our long time ally the Free Repub. of China on Taiwan, *that it,* quote "opposes the creation of 2 Chinas, an independent Taiwan or a separate solution" unquote. The U.S. in turn says quote "that it does not challenge this view." To Americans this was plain English that ~~m~~eant we neither agreed nor disagreed—we simply avoided the issue.

Unfortunately it is not that easy & simple. The Chinese translation of the phrase, "does not challenge" is taken to mean that because we ~~hav~~ make no objection we agree with ~~t~~ Chinas position. Then there is a sentence to the effect that there should be a peaceful solution to the problem of Taiwan. We would interpret that to mean that Peking ~~dosen~~'~~t~~ wont launch an attack or try to conquer Taiwan by force of arms. Again Peking denies that this language binds them to seek a peaceful solution.

We have an example ~~th~~ in the Panama Canal treaties that came to light early in the Sen. debate. Senators were proposing amendments to the treaties ~~with~~ *which* apparently didn't disturb the Panamanians—until the Panamanians realized what we meant by amendment. To us an amendment is a ~~bind-ing~~ clause as binding as the original treaty—as witness amendments to our constitution.

To them "enmienda" (amendment) is just a minor change in wording—alright if it is just included in an existing clause but definitely a no-no if it's added as an additional paragraph. Then it becomes serious business.

As we approach the Salt II talks with Russia we should keep in mind that Russian is a far more complicated language than Spanish. Besides which the Russians dont keep their word even when they understand the meaning.

This is RR Thanks for listening. ❖

China

April 3, 1978

T'was Bobby Burns the poet who said something to the effect of having the gift to see ourselves as others see us.* I'll be right back.

In this time of doubt & mistrust in ~~our own~~ *the* land when we are ~~fearful of &~~ curbing the ability of our own intelligence machinery to keep us informed, it is especially interesting to note how effective by contrast are the Chinese in the Free Republic on Taiwan. ~~≠~~ Their record of ~~bringing out~~ *making public* top secret material from the Red Chinese on the mainland is fantastic and I might add very helpful to us.

For example we now have the complete text of a 42,000 word *several hour* speech by Red Chinas Foreign Minister Huang Hua delivered July 30 to all the top level govt. & party functionaries meeting in Peking. It was a complete report on the entire world situation & definitely not for public consumption.** Repeatedly throughout the address Huang cautioned his audience against talking about anything they ~~h~~ were hearing.

Now you know of course I'm not going to give you all 42,000 words. But I thought you might be interested in how we look to the Chinese communists who want ~~us~~ to "normalize relations" with us—providing we'll forget about our friendship with Taiwan.

Huang referred to the Shanghai Communique jointly signed by our two countries as "like other treaties & agreements—merely something on paper." He then went on to say, "~~"~~The U.S. does not have the strength to deter the resolution of the Chinese people to liberate Taiwan."~~—~~We will simply regard ~~thei~~ "~~(their~~ *their* treaty with Taiwan~~)~~ "as a scrap of paper." He suggested that it was nothing more than that to us and asked if the American people have the will to share the fate of Taiwan if & when the Mainland govt. sets out to conquer the Free Republic of China. Answering his own question he said, "Go read Am. history, we have not seen such an instance in which the U.S. has had such resolve & courage to sacrifice for others. That is why we dare to conclude that the U.S. is a paper tiger. It can be said that we have the deepest insight into the U.S. and, after having dealt with it for such a long time, we can paint not only it's skin, but also it's bones."

*"To A Louse," in James A. Mackay, ed., *The Complete Poetical Works of Robert Burns, 1759–1796* (Scotland: Alloway Publishing Ltd., 1993), 181–82.

**See "Huang Hua's Report on the World Situation," *Issues and Studies: A Journal of China Studies and International Affairs* 13 (Nov. 1977): 78–84; (Dec. 1977): 76–94; 14 (Jan. 1978): 94–116; and (Feb. 1978): 77–88.

Now that isn't the picture we have of ourselves & history (overall) does not support Huangs image of us. But we should note the examples from recent history he used to support his view; the firing of McArthur* in Korea because he wanted to win the war & our failure to be decisive in Vietnam. He spoke of, "the frailty of the paper tiger that could not withstand a beating" and described us as standing absolutely alone without "a single dedicated fellow traveler."

There is great danger to us in this false image making. It is more often than not the road to war. The Kaiser didn't think we'd fight no matter how great the provocation and Hitler had the same idea. Then there was Pearl Harbor.

Huang said *in effect* China would be patient until it had the relationship it wanted with us and then it would liberate Taiwan and we wouldn't lift a finger. If we really want peace we'd better remind the world of that America ~~they~~ it seems to have forgotten.—We'd better remind ourselves that "paper tigers" ~~get~~ are easily torn up.

This is RR Thanks for listening. ❖

Taiwan I

January 1979

Shouldn't a nation be bound by the moral code of it's people? And can a govt. act dishonorably without ~~dishonoring~~ *bringing dishonor to* it's people? I'll be right back.

Someone once said ~~each~~ *every* form of govt. has a single characteristic which forms the basis for it's ~~being~~ *power;* if that is lost the govt. falls. Monarchy *for example* is based on the affection & respect of the people for the Royal family. When that respect & affection disappears the monarchy falls. Dictatorship is *based on fear, it is* successful ~~because~~ *only so long as* the people fear the dictator. In a Democracy the underlying principle is virtue, when that is lost the democracy ~~is lost~~ *fails &* ceases to exist.

There came a moment in W.W.II. when the Japanese offered Chiang Kai-Shek a separate peace on the most generous terms. He of course knew that the Chinese communists in northern China had an army ready & waiting to seize power—as they subsequently did. The Japanese offer had to be very tempting to the Generalissimo. ~~who~~ *He* could have turned his *FULL* attention ~~& used his army~~ to the red army & guarantyd the continuation of his own regime.

The Japanese of course would have been able to ~~turn~~ *THROW* the entire army fighting on the mainland of China against our forces in the So. Pacific.

Chiang Kai-Shek told our General Wedemeyer of the Japanese offer and of his refusal to make a separate peace. He said that he could not betray his friend & ally, the United States: that he would fight to the end by our side.

In *SPITE OF* all ~~of~~ the platitudinous talk, the reiteration of arguments that the declaration by the Pres. Dec. 15th was simple realization of reality one fact remains very clear: The United States, for the first time in it's history, broke a treaty without cause. We callously betrayed a long time friend & ally which had ≠ refused to betray us. And we did so with a brutal rudeness. ~~The act~~

During the 2 years of the Carter admin. there has been a deliberate snubbing of the govt. on Taiwan.; ~~a~~An Asian journey by our Vice Pres. took in virtually every country of the western Pacific except Taiwan. We sent no representative to the inauguration of the Pres. of the Repub. of China, the son of Chiang Kai-Shek. And there was no consultation with the new Pres. warning him of our decision to accept the terms laid down by the Communist rulers in Peking. What our govt. did was entirely lacking in virtue.

My next commentary will continue on this subject.

This is RR Thanks for listening. ❖

Taiwan's Future

March 6, 1979

We've been told—maybe re-assured is the proper word—that the Repub. of China on Taiwan is so strong that an attack from the mainland is highly unlikely. But is it?

Defense dept. officials including Sec. Brown have told the Senate Foreign Relations Committee that Taiwan could survive any concerted attack by the Peoples Repub. of China—so therefore it's unlikely there would be such an attack for years & years to come ~~,~~ *if ever.*

On the last broadcast I told of the shenanigans in that Sen. committee which will make any resolution of U.S. support for Taiwan so weak as to be meaningless. That is unless Senators attempt to amend some muscle into the committee bill on the floor.

~~And what~~ *Now* about that Defense Dept. testimony to the committee that Taiwan ~~was~~ *is* strong enough to take care of itself~~?~~ There has been other testimony which was totally unreported by such papers as the N.Y. Times & the Wash. Post—testimony to that same Sen. Foreign Relations Committee. Fortunately a Wash. weekly called "Human Events" has made it possible for us to know about that testimony.*

Vice Admiral Edwin K. Snyder U.S. Navy Retired, told the Sen. Committee that Taiwans defenses would have to undergo a vast modernization program to successfully withstand a sustained assault from the mainland. And it would seem that Admiral Snyders opinion would carry some weight with the Senators. From August of 1974 to August 1977 he was commander of the U.S. Taiwan Defense Command. He was responsible to the Joint Chiefs of Staff for contingency planning for the defense of the Repub. of China including Taiwan & the Pescadores Island.

Just giving Taiwan the weapons presently in the pipeline wont be enough. The Admiral says the R.O.C. wouldn't have a chance if it didn't get such all weather fighter planes as the F-16, Harpoon missiles to stand off the Chinese navy & special anti-submarine equipment. All of this is equipment our 7th

*"Ex-Defense Commander Says Taiwan Vulnerable," *Human Events* (Feb. 24, 1979): 4.

fleet would have provided under the mutual defense treaty we are now scrapping.

The admiral further says that without our carrier planes the Taiwan airforce would be neutralized within 2 or 3 weeks. The mainland Chinese navy would pit patrol boats & modern destroyers both armed with surface to surface missiles against 20 old W.W.II destroyers armed with 5 inch guns. And the greatest threat is the Communist Chinese submarine force—almost double the number we have in our whole Pacific ~~navy~~ *fleet.*

Admiral Snyder believes that the island Republic's lines of supply & communications could be disrupted in fairly short order. His message is clear, if Congress fails to make certain that Taiwan receives advanced weaponry ~~it could the Rep~~ the free Repub. of China could be enslaved by the rulers in Peking. And yet it dosen't seem as if the Sen. committee is listening.

This is RR Thanks for listening.

Japan III

May 15, 1978

If you dont mind I'd like to spend another few minutes talking about our visit to Japan & a widespread worry they have. I'll be right back.

Renewing the acquaintance ~~with~~ *of* Prime Minister Fukuda of Japan, former Prime Minister Kishi,** leaders of the majority party, members of the cabinet and legislature and of course meeting *SOME* govt. officials for the first time was an enjoyable & rewarding experience. On one evening we had dinner with some half a hundred members of both houses of the Diet—the Japanese legislative body.

It was a remarkable experience. We each had a microphone & head set for the lengthy question & answer session so there was instant 2 way transla-

*Muhammad Reza Shah Pahlavi and Farah Diba.

**Prime Minister Takeo Fukuda and Prime Minister Nobusuke Kishi.

tion. For many it was unnecessary because they spoke our language. This was true of the other individual meetings also although an interpreter was present for ~~others~~ *SOME*. In my speaking engagements we simplified the process by providing Japanese *LANGUAGE* copies of my remarks to everyone present. I'll guaranty you I didn't do any ad-libbing on those occasions. *But I couldn't help but notice how many in the audience were obviously listening & understanding what I said.*

In all these meetings one topic was uppermost in the mind of each person I met. Is the United States withdrawing from the western Pacific? They quoted statements by our leaders, ~~some of which had never~~ *which seemed to indicate such a withdrawal was possible.* They brought up our troop withdrawal from S. Korea, the talk of normalizing relations with the mainland Chinese at the expense of Taiwan & the growing strength of the Soviet Navy in the northwest Pacific.

These were not uninformed citizens worrying about things they had read in the paper. These were ~~the~~ *the knowledgeable* men responsible for 113 mil. people. And since W.W. II totally dependant on the U.S. for their national security. This was the responsibility we assumed in return for their disarming *& disavowing militarism.*

I was to meet this same question in other countries, friendly to us but deeply concerned about a U.S. foreign policy that seems unrealistic & incomprehensible to them.

I tried to tell them of polls showing that Americans want an improvement in our mil. capability, that the Am. people do not support a policy that would abrogate our treaty with the Republic of China on Taiwan and that we intend to maintain a presence in S. Korea. On that last point I had my fingers crossed because frankly I wonder if our govt. does intend to maintain such a presence *or for that matter pay attention to the expressed desire of the people.*

~~One cannot hear the views of these leaders of Asian nations without increasing~~

It was frustrating to hear national leaders *friendly* to the U.S. asking for some assurance that our country has the will to accept leadership of the free world. And they made it very plain there was no other nation with the strength to do so if we abdicated that responsibility.

Our presence in Japan, S. Korea, Taiwan & the Phillipines is absolutely essential to the stability of the western Pacific and actually to peace & freedom in the world. We must be prepared to maintain the 7th fleet at a level of strength capable of keeping the sea lanes open in the northern Pacific & in the Indian Ocean.

This is RR Thanks for listening. ❖

Human Rights

January 1979

Now that we are going to have an embassy in Peking we may have to make some fundamental changes in our foreign policy. I'll be right back.

A few weeks ago on one of these broadcasts I told the story of an entertainer, a juggler in a show ~~troupe~~ *TROOP* who made a sudden decision to change countries. He was a citizen of the Peoples Repub. of China and the ~~*troupe*~~ *troop* he was with was performing in the Sudan. After an evening performance he made his way to ~~the~~ a Sudanese govt. office & asked to be sent to Taiwan. They bought him an airline ticket & he became a free man.

We know of course that literally tens of thousands of mainland Chinese every year make their way to ~~H~~ the British outpost, Hong Kong. Some of these swim through miles of shark infested waters, so determined are they to

*"Interview With Representatives of Chinese Central Television in Beijing, China," *Public Papers of the Presidents of the United States: Ronald Reagan, 1984* (Washington, DC: Government Printing Office, 1986), 588.

escape their homeland. And of course a number of them then make their way to Taiwan where there is freedom & the 3rd highest standard of living in all of Asia.

I mention this & the jugglers story because it connects with the administrations unexpected move to establish diplomatic relations with Red China. Not too long ago Pres. Carter said "human rights" ~~were~~ *was* the soul of his foreign policy. There are few countries in the world where human rights are more non-existant than in the Peoples Repub. of China. One wonders if the Pres. will address the rulers in Peking through ~~our~~ *his* new Ambassador on this matter of "human rights." Will he for instance bring up the ~~Peoples Re public~~ backing ~~of~~ *by* the Peoples Republic, of the inhumane regime in Cambodia which is practising genocide on it's own citizens. The horror stories from that once happy land top anything in the world for sheer inhumanity.

But within the Peoples Repub. itself the violation of all human rights is confirmed by literally thousands of stories told by ~~the~~ escapees. Visitors to China of course do not see this because visitors are shown only the showcase China. When a U.S. Senator *of Chinese origin* ~~in Peking~~ on an official visit to Peking asked to be allowed to visit the village where his parents had lived he was bluntly refused permission.

I've talked of our betrayal of the 17 mil. Chinese on Taiwan—haven't we also betrayed mil's. & mil's. of Chinese on the mainland who lived with a dream of one day regaining freedom? We have legitimized their slave masters.

This is RR Thanks for listening. ❖